Jacob Ong

I'm Jacob Ong, 22, writing from Singapore.

THE NEW VOID DECK

A public record of my own reasoning about economics. Reasoning that stays in your head never gets tested. Reasoning published under your own name, with the falsifier attached, does.

Every piece publishes its data and its code, so anyone can rebuild the figures and check whether I got it right.

RESEARCH

Every piece published so far, newest first.

- **For low-paid gardeners, the floor became the pay**
  Minimum wage or the Progressive Wage Model: which actually lifts Singapore's lowest pay?
  Published 31 October 2026. Predictions sealed 28 September 2026. Scorecard: 3 held, 1 failed. Code
- **Roads got about a quarter more crowded. Speeds held.**
  COE or ERP: which one actually keeps Singapore's roads moving?
  Published 17 October 2026. Predictions sealed 26 September 2026. Scorecard: 1 held, 2 failed, 1 in between. Code
- **Early HDB loans lost to any bank charging under 1.4 points**
  Was the HDB loan really cheaper than a bank's?
  Published 3 October 2026. Predictions sealed 17 September 2026. Scorecard: 5 held, 3 failed. Code
- **A four-room flat takes fewer years of income than in 2013**
  Is an HDB flat really harder to afford than it used to be?
  Published 19 September 2026. Predictions sealed 11 September 2026. Scorecard: 3 held, 2 failed, 4 in between. Code
- **Motorcycle COEs fell 17%. Car COEs rose 43%.**
  Why did motorcycle COEs fall while car COEs hit records?
  Published 12 September 2026. Written before predictions were sealed; not scored. Code
- **Water bills show about the full GST rise. The national price index cannot see it.**
  Where did the GST rises actually show up in prices?
  Published 8 September 2026. Predictions sealed 4 September 2026. Scorecard: 1 held, 4 failed, 1 in between. Code
- **Two in three COE bids win. It is not a lottery.**
  Is getting a COE just a lottery?
  Published 5 September 2026. Written before predictions were sealed; not scored. Code
- **Perfect COE timing is worth $1,840. Nobody has it.**
  Is one of the two monthly COE bidding rounds reliably cheaper?
  Published 29 August 2026. Written before predictions were sealed; not scored. Code
- **The COE quota went up 62%. Prices nearly quadrupled anyway.**
  Are COE prices high because the government keeps cutting the quota?
  Published 22 August 2026. Written before predictions were sealed; not scored. Code

TRACK RECORD

The scorecard lists every prediction sealed before the data was opened, and what happened to it, failures included.

HOW THE WORK IS CHECKED

The rules every piece follows, from sealing its predictions to reporting the ones that failed, are set out in How the economics research works.

BACKGROUND

A polytechnic graduate in banking and finance, recently out of National Service, currently on a traineeship at a bank and applying to read economics at university. I'm not an analyst, and I'm not licensed by the Monetary Authority of Singapore. If anything here reads as authority, that's a failure in the writing rather than a claim I'm making.

What I do have is the habit of writing down what would prove me wrong and, since September 2026, of sealing each prediction before I open the data.

WORKING WITH AI

I designed and run the research workflow behind this site. Inside it, Claude, an AI model made by Anthropic, does the research, coding and drafting. I write the specifications, decide what counts as evidence, and do the editorial pass. That came out of a view I formed early: AI is going to change how this kind of research gets done, and I would rather learn to direct it well than learn the old way and adapt later.

It also came with a lesson. Nearly every rule on the How the scorecard works page exists because an early version of one of these systems produced something fluent and wrong. The rules are what's left after that.

UNIVERSITY AND QUALIFICATIONS

Next comes economics at university. I completed the FMVA certification in October 2026, and the CFA charter is somewhere further down the road.

WHY I BUILT THE SITE

Three reasons, in order of honesty.

To build something that shows what I can actually do, rather than telling people about it.

To stay disciplined. A public page you have to keep updating is a harder taskmaster than a private folder you can quietly abandon. Writing in the open keeps me honest about the work and keeps me doing it.

And because I'd like this to still exist in twenty years. Somewhere in here is a record of how I thought at 22, what I got right, what I got badly wrong, and how long I stuck with it. If I ever have kids, I'd rather hand them that than a story about it.

INTERESTS

Badminton, Texas hold'em, and American mahjong. All three reward the same thing: reading a situation with incomplete information, staying calm when it turns, and thinking a few moves ahead. I got better at reasoning with incomplete information partly by getting better at those.

CONTACT

My email is EMAIL_TO_CONFIRM. Questions and counter-arguments can also go through the question form.

> *"Wealth gained hastily will dwindle, but whoever gathers little by little will increase it."*
> *Proverbs 13:11*

Mistakes that reach publication are mine.